

Tracking Your Financial Progress Over Time

How to monitor, measure, and improve your financial health month by month | Uganda SACCO Regulatory Authority

Why Tracking Matters

Knowing your financial situation today is useful. Tracking how it changes over 3, 6, and 12 months is transformational. Tracking shows you whether you are improving, stagnating, or moving backward — and gives you the evidence to make better decisions.

SACCO members who track their finances monthly are significantly more likely to reach their savings goals, maintain clean loan repayment records, and qualify for larger loans when they need them.

The Monthly Financial Check — Five Questions to Answer Every Month

Question 1: Did my income increase, decrease, or stay the same compared to last month? If it decreased, does my budget reflect that change?

Question 2: Did I make my full loan repayment on time? If not, what caused the shortfall, and how do I prevent it next month?

Question 3: Did I save my target amount? If not, what expense consumed it — and was that expense planned or a surprise?

Question 4: Is my outstanding loan balance decreasing each month as expected? Request a statement from your SACCO every quarter to confirm.

Question 5: Am I closer to my savings goal than I was last month? Calculate the exact gap and the new expected completion date.

Your Monthly Tracking Template

Item	Last Month	This Month
Monthly income	UGX ____	UGX ____
Total expenses	UGX ____	UGX ____
Loan repayment (paid)	UGX ____	UGX ____
Savings deposited	UGX ____	UGX ____
Outstanding loan balance	UGX ____	UGX ____
Emergency fund balance	UGX ____	UGX ____
Goal savings balance	UGX ____	UGX ____
Monthly surplus or deficit	UGX ____	UGX ____

Fill this in on the last day of every month. Keep three months of records side by side to see trends — not just snapshots.

Key Financial Ratios to Monitor Over Time

Ratio	How to Calculate	Healthy Target
Loan repayment ratio	$\text{Monthly EMI} \div \text{Monthly income} \times 100$	Below 20%
Savings rate	$\text{Monthly savings} \div \text{Monthly income} \times 100$	10–20% minimum
Expense ratio	$\text{Total expenses} \div \text{Monthly income} \times 100$	Below 80%
Emergency fund coverage	$\text{Emergency fund} \div \text{Monthly expenses}$	2–3 months
Loan progress	$\text{Amount repaid} \div \text{Original principal} \times 100$	Increasing monthly

Track these ratios monthly. A ratio moving in the right direction — even slowly — is a sign of financial progress. A ratio that is worsening for two or more consecutive months signals a problem that needs attention now.

Celebrating Progress and Adjusting Goals

Financial tracking should not feel like punishment. Acknowledge milestones: the first time your emergency fund reaches UGX 200,000, the halfway point of your loan repayment, reaching your first savings goal.

When you hit a goal, immediately set the next one. Members who go from one goal to the next continuously are the ones who build real long-term wealth.

When you miss a target: do not abandon the system. Investigate the cause, adjust the plan, and continue. One bad month does not undo months of good habits.

Using Your SACCO as a Financial Partner

Your SACCO is not just a lender — it is a financial cooperative that benefits when its members succeed. Use it accordingly:

Request a free account statement every quarter. Verify that all your payments are recorded correctly and your balance is decreasing as expected.

Ask your SACCO officer to review your repayment progress annually. A good officer will tell you when you qualify for a top-up loan or a higher savings interest tier.

If your income increases significantly, consider increasing your SACCO savings contribution. Higher savings balance means higher loan eligibility — building your borrowing power for when you truly need it.

Inform your SACCO promptly of any life change that affects your repayment ability — a job change, a health crisis, a business setback. Early communication preserves the relationship and often results in a flexible repayment arrangement.